

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Tabbssum Alam

Address: 41 Balmoral Way Sutton SM2 6PD

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I wish to formally record my support for planning application DM2025/01591. The proposed change of use from the former ambulance station to a community hub and place of worship will benefit the local community in various aspects as follows.

The programme of activities is designed to be inclusive and welcoming. This is a shared community resource, not a closed facility. Educational classes, wellbeing sessions, family activities, and interfaith events will bring residents together.

It provides the kind of community space that supports mental health, reduces isolation, and gives people a reason to come together. From a public health perspective, this proposal is valuable. This is particularly important for elderly residents and those from communities who may face barriers to accessing mainstream services.

The application recognises that women, families, and elderly residents have specific needs that are not currently being met locally. The dedicated provision in this proposal is a thoughtful and practical response to that reality.

Compared to the former ambulance station, which ran 24 hours a day with emergency vehicles and sirens at all hours, the proposed use is much calmer. Operating hours are restricted, there are no large vehicles, and the activities are community-based rather than emergency-response. Neighbours will notice the difference.

In addition, I would note that refusing this application would require the Council to justify that

decision against a strong policy presumption in favour of community facility provision. The NPPF, London Plan, and Sutton Local Plan all support this type of use.

Furthermore, the Transport Statement has addressed this directly and the evidence is clear. I understand why parents might worry about school-run congestion, but the timings of Friday prayers simply do not overlap with school drop-off or pick-up as planned by the committee.

This proposal ticks every box: it is policy-compliant, well-evidenced, and really needed. I request the Council to kindly grant planning permission for DM2025/01591.